DOPPELGANGER: ANALYSIS AND REFLECTIONS UPON A MULTI-PERFORMER, MULTIMODAL WORK FOR UNENCUMBERED WIRELESS WEARABLE SYSTEMS

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ABSTRACT

This paper examines the creative process and thinking behind new multi-media performance work Doppelgänger. The work examines the use of multiple unencumbered wireless performance interfaces to drive multiple media elements in the performance. The performers simultaneously perform lighting and music elements using free arm and hand gestures. Performer one controls an intelligent light system that moves theatrical lights and changes light parameters in response to the performer's gestures, while performer two controls the music elements in a similar way.

The body and choreography are at the centre of the work and the work explores a number of questions:

• What correlations or congruities form in terms of the gestures of the two performers responding to and in the case of the second performer also controlling elements of the music.

• What correlations are there between the media elements and how does motion and spatiality in particular relate between the body, lights and music?

• How do the bodily gestures relate to and inform the mapping relationships of both media elements?

• What, if any, hierarchies emerge between the different media throughout the composition process.

• What role do metaphors play and what audio-visual metaphors exist in the work?

The paper draws upon multi-modal analytical techniques, with a particular focus on the Interacting Cognitive Subsystems (ICS) model of cognition developed by Phil Barnard. This model will be applied to the development of Doppelgänger in order to explain some of the creative and intuitive decisions that were made during the creative process.